

What We Built · What to Include Next · Future Compete

Audience: founders, investors, SE / design partners · Tech-only · Sunset Clay product · July 2026
Companion to: *Que-Tech-Diligence-Investor.pdf*

One-line truth: Que is a *join HITL* → *freeze* → *attested export/PR* appliance on a schema-metadata plane. It is **ready for a controlled paid POC**. It is **not** “replace Atlan/Collibra this quarter,” and **not** unattended multi-tenant SaaS at a Big-4 audit bar — yet.

Contents

- 1. Hard claims — allowed vs forbidden now
- 2. What we have built (inventory)
- 3. What must be included next (near-term)
- 4. Competitive levels today
- 5. Future — compete with Atlan / Collibra / Alation / DataHub
- 6. Future — Big-4 multi-tenant SaaS bar
- 7. Phased roadmap (when each claim becomes honest)

1. Hard claims — allowed vs forbidden now

Allowed now (honest)	Forbidden now (do not say)
• Paid design-partner POC with fixed SOW (2–3 sources) • Human-approved cross-source joins • Contract freeze + HMAC-attested JSON / SQL / dbt export • Optional GitHub dbt PR from approved contracts • Schema-only defaults; scrubbed/capped samples • Encrypted warehouse credentials; workspace roles + invites	• “Replace Atlan / Collibra this quarter” • Full enterprise catalog / glossary / stewardship OS • Complete multi-hop column lineage everywhere • Unattended multi-tenant SaaS at Big-4 audit bar • SOC 2 Type II / SCIM / contractual SLA already done • Unity Catalog or Snowflake Horizon replacement

Diligence fails when Phase-0 software is sold with Phase-3/4 category language. Sell the **wedge**; roadmap the **category**.

2. What we have built (inventory)

Everything below is implemented and demoable in the current Que stack (Vite SPA + Express API + Postgres/pgvector).

BUILT Access & tenancy

- Create account / sign in; optional OIDC SSO (PKCE, JWKS, hash token delivery)
- Create / switch workspaces; invite members; pending invites; role change / remove
- Roles: viewer → member → admin → owner (last-owner protections)
- In-app onboarding roadmap dialog (Skip / Next / Done; reopen via ?)

BUILT Sources, schema, joins

- Connectors: PostgreSQL, Databricks, Snowflake, Excel/CSV, Mongo (fixture and/or live)
- Encrypted credentials at rest (__enc AES-GCM)
- Sync → canvas graph; join inference; **Promote / Reject** HITL; stitch session
- Optional Databricks query-history assist for joins

BUILT Privacy, AI, chat

- Schema-only defaults; sample scrub; policy toggles in Settings
- Chat skills + optional LLM/RAG; capped sample previews
- Job draft from chat → **Save to Jobs** with deep-link navigation

BUILT Jobs & ship path

- Notebook cells; dry-run; capped live validate (read-oriented)
- Export JSON / SQL / dbt / optional dbt-PR to GitHub
- Contract freeze; drift gates; HMAC attestation + verify endpoint

BUILT Security & ops spine

- Prod boot gates (secrets, CORS, no auth bypass); health endpoint
- Automated diligence / unit / smoke / Playwright browser E2E
- Docs: Feature Guide, Local Setup, Manual Test Plan, Investor Diligence PDF

POC success definition

N promoted joins + 1 attested export (JSON or dbt) + precision/recall on *their* golden join pairs — not “catalog coverage %.”

Partial / demo risk

Join *evidence* UX on every edge; Settings billing stubs; live warehouse quality varies by customer network/tokens.

3. What must be included next (near-term)

Include these **before** chasing catalog parity with Atlan/Collibra. They harden the wedge.

#	Include	Why it matters	When
P0.1	Join evidence on every suggested edge (signals + optional SQL snippet)	Trust hinge in every SE demo	NEXT
P0.2	Customer golden-set eval → printable POC report	Investor / SE proof of join quality	NEXT
P0.3	One-click POC pack (migrate, fixtures, verify attestation)	Days-not-weeks time-to-value	NEXT
P0.4	Hide billing / upgrade stubs outside DEV	Credibility with paid buyers	NEXT
P0.5	Audit log export + session revoke + basic rate limits	Minimum enterprise hygiene	NEXT
P1.1	Snowflake query-history join mining (parity with DBX)	Cross-cloud SF↔DBX wedge	SOON
P1.2	Deeper dbt manifest round-trip	Ship into real customer repos	SOON
P1.3	GitHub check showing attestation fingerprint + approved join IDs	Non-repudiation in CI	SOON

Also include in every paid POC SOW: fixed sources, success = promoted joins + attested artifact, golden-set evaluation, no claim of full lineage or catalog replacement, optional GH PR (token provided by customer).

4. Competitive levels today

Score relative to category incumbents. **Strong** = Que wins the niche; **Partial** = usable but not parity; **Weak / Gap** = do not compete here yet.

Capability	Atlan / Alation / Collibra / DataHub	Unity / Horizon	Que today	Level
Asset breadth, glossary, stewardship	Strong	Platform-native	Not built (by design)	Gap
Automated multi-hop column lineage at scale	Stronger when configured	Strong in-platform	Inference + optional DBX history	Partial
Cross-source join HITL → freeze	Rare as first-class loop	In-platform only	Core product loop	Strong
Attested schema-only export / dbt PR	Rare	N/A as product	Core product loop	Strong
Time-to-value for DE POC	Weeks–months	Fast if already on platform	Days with fixtures/docs	Strong
Enterprise IdP (SCIM), SOC2 evidence	Expected	Expected	Not there	Gap
Query / warehouse governance	Partial	Native	Out of scope	Gap
AI suggestions with mandatory human review	Mixed	Platform-tied	Promote/Reject required	Strong

Competitive posture: do not beat them on catalog completeness. Beat them on a **narrow DE workflow they under-serve**: trusted, reviewable, shippable join contracts across systems.

Who Que is / is not competing with (now)

Competing now (wedge)	Not competing yet (category)
Manual join discovery across SF / DBX / PG Spreadsheet / tribal knowledge of keys Hand-written dbt joins with no attestation Catalogs that stop at “search” without a PR	Atlan / Collibra / Alation as catalog of record DataHub as enterprise metadata OS Unity Catalog / Horizon as platform control plane Big-4-audited unattended SaaS platforms

5. Future — compete with Atlan / Collibra / Alation / DataHub

“Replace Atlan/Collibra this quarter” is a **category claim**. It requires becoming a catalog + governance platform, not only a join-shipping appliance. Build only if strategy expands — *after* wedge revenue.

NOT THIS QUARTER Do not market glossary depth, stewardship workflows, or full column lineage you have not built. Competitors already lose deals on incomplete lineage — overclaiming is fatal.

FUTURE A Catalog breadth (parity table stakes)

- Connectors at scale: BigQuery, Redshift, Synapse, Glue, Kafka, S3 lakes, Airflow / OpenLineage ingest
- Asset types beyond tables: dashboards, metrics, ML features, pipelines as first-class nodes
- Search ranked by popularity/usage; duplicate dataset detection
- Business glossary + term↔table linking; stewardship (certify, expire, owner queues)
- Automated multi-hop **column lineage** across SQL + dbt + BI
- Quality / profiling signals (null rates, freshness) — privacy-gated

FUTURE B Governance & collaboration (Collibra / Alation territory)

- Policy packs: PII tags, retention, access-request tickets
- Workflow engine: approvals, RACI, scheduled digests
- Integrations: Jira / ServiceNow, Slack / Teams
- Domain / data-product modeling; steward UX mode without killing the DE wedge

FUTURE C AI enterprises will trust

- Grounded answers with citations to lineage edges + owners
- Hallucination eval harnesses; schema-only guarantees in contract language
- Optional “propose PR” with **mandatory HITL** (keep Que’s DNA)

Honest future claim (only after Phase 3 depth): “Works as catalog + join-shipping platform beside or instead of lighter catalog installs” — still not a casual “replace Collibra overnight” soundbite.

6. Future — Big-4 audit bar multi-tenant SaaS

Unattended multi-tenant SaaS sold into Big-4-audited enterprises needs a **control plane + evidence pack**, not just features. Que is **not there yet**.

NOT YET Do not claim SOC 2 Type II, SCIM directory sync, HA isolation proof, pen-test pack, or contractual uptime SLAs until evidence exists.

Area	Must add to reach the bar
Identity	SCIM 2.0; org-wide SSO enforce; break-glass; session revoke UI; scoped API keys; optional CMK
Compliance evidence	SOC 2 Type II (then ISO if needed); annual pen-test; SBOM; immutable audit export; DPA / residency options
Tenant reliability	Hard isolation + automated isolation tests; HA Postgres; backups/PITR; DR RPO/RTO drilled; queues; rate limits
Ops & delivery	Observability + status page; on-call; SLAs; VPC / private link; optional self-hosted gateway; admin console

Big-4 buyers ask for **evidence**, not slideware. Budget calendar time for audit — not only engineering features.

7. Phased roadmap — when each claim becomes honest

Phase	Goal	Build focus	Claim you may make
0 — Now	Paid design-partner POC	Wedge reliability, evidence UX, golden-set reports, hide stubs	"Join HITL → freeze → attested PR"
1 — Wedge scale	Repeatable DE POCs	SF query history, deeper dbt, GH checks, audit export	"Cross-source join contracts for DE teams"
2 — Platform light	Expand without catalog lie	More connectors, BI lineage depth, better admin	"Works beside your catalog"
3 — Catalog compete	Only if strategy expands	Glossary, stewardship, column lineage at scale (\$5)	Cautious catalog language — still not "replace this quarter"
4 — Big-4 SaaS	Unattended enterprise	SCIM, SOC2 T2, HA/isolation, pen-test, SLAs (\$6)	"Enterprise-ready multi-tenant" (with evidence)

Summary for investors / SE:
Built: the DE join-shipping wedge (auth, sources, HITL, jobs, attestation, docs/tests).
Include next: evidence UX, golden-set POC report, POC pack, hygiene (audit/revoke/hide stubs), SF history + deeper dbt/CI.
Future compete: catalog breadth + governance only in Phase 3; Big-4 SaaS only in Phase 4.
Do not say now: "replace Atlan/Collibra this quarter" · "unattended multi-tenant at Big-4 audit bar."